



Brand orientation of nonprofit organizations and its relationship with the attitude toward charity and donation intention

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Abstract

This study aimed to verify the effects that the factors which constitute the brand orientation exert on the attitude toward charity and the donation intention. A model capable of indicating the relationship between the dimensions of brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations (orchestration, interaction and affect) with the attitude toward charity and donation intention was developed. The target population is comprised of Brazilians who know about Nonprofit Organizations. A sample of 340 respondents was obtained. The proposed model was analyzed through Structural Equations Modeling (SEM) with partial least squares (PLS) measurement. The results support the hypothesis that the attitude toward charity has a significant influence on the intention of the Brazilians respondents to donate to Nonprofit Organizations and that the interaction dimension positively influences the attitude toward charity and the donation intention of these individuals, while the dimension of orchestration only influences the attitude towards charity, and the dimension affects only the donation intention.

Keywords Brand orientation · Nonprofit organizations · Donation intention · Attitude toward charity

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1 Introduction

Nonprofit Organizations play a key role in society, representing an important element for the economy and development of various countries (Hassay and Peloza 2009; Apaydin 2011; Modi 2012; Chad et al. 2013). With the expansion in the number of these organizations there was an increase in the dispute over resources (Laidler-Kylander et al. 2007; Weerawardena and Mort 2008; Michel and Rieunier 2012), which made fundraising a more difficult task, leading these organizations to seek ways to improve fundraising to keep their operation (Sargeant 1999; Vázquez et al. 2002; Chad 2013).

In this context, Nonprofit Organizations began to notice the need to employ marketing practices similar to those adopted by the commercial sector (Ewing and Napoli 2005; Macedo and Pinho 2006). Among these practices, brand orientation is pointed out as attractive to Nonprofit Organizations (Hankinson 2001; Apaydin 2011; Napoli 2006; Stebbins and Hartman 2013). Brand orientation refers to how the organization deliberately creates, develops and protects its brands in order to achieve its organizational objectives (Liu et al. 2015). Its application unifies internal and external actors around a common purpose and gives organizations better results (Laidler-Kylander et al. 2007; Kylander and Stone 2012).

It was verified in the literature that as the contributions of brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations were identified, it happened to be object of study in diverse investigations in the nonprofit sector (e.g., Hankinson 2000, 2001; Ewing and Napoli 2005; Napoli 2006; Mulyanegara 2011; Apaydin 2011). However, there are still several research opportunities on brand orientation in Nonprofit Organizations (Laidler-Kylander and Simonin 2009; Modi and Mishra 2010; Modi 2012; Chad et al. 2013).

Based on the foregoing, it can be seen that the studies which investigated the brand of Nonprofit Organizations (Hankinson 2000, 2001; Ewing and Napoli 2005; Napoli 2006) brought evidence of brand orientation in charitable organizations, identifying ways of verifying it and perceiving its relation with performance. However, such research does not make any reference to the relation of brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations with the attitude toward charity and donation intention. Thus, this study aimed to verify the effects that the factors which constitute the brand orientation exert on the attitude toward charity and the donation intention.

The present research is theoretically justified by extending the understanding of the brand of Nonprofit Organizations, demonstrating that its constituent factors can influence the attitude toward charity and donation intention. Thus, it can affect, for example, the pretension of the use of its services and the donations of time, money and/or goods. Differently from other investigations that analyzed brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations, such as Ewing and Napoli (2005), Napoli (2006) and Apaydin (2011), this study verifies how its elements relate to and affect factors external to these organizations.

In this perspective, the literature presents evidence of the influence of brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations in donation intention. However, most studies developed in this area have given little emphasis on the contributions that the brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations can exert on fomenting donations (Venable et al. 2005; Stebbins and Hartman 2013). For example, the need for more research which explores brand orientation and the intention to donate is pointed out by Hankinson (2001), Napoli (2006), Apaydin (2011) and Zhang et al. (2019).

Therefore, one of the contributions of this study is the development of a model capable of identifying the association between the factors that comprise the brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations (Ewing and Napoli 2005; Napoli 2006), the attitude toward charity (Dean 2002) and the donation intention (Wang et al. 2004). This allows a better understanding of how brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations can influence fundraising, representing new possibilities for analyzing brand orientation in this sector. It is important to highlight that the main novelty of this study is the analysis of the dimensions of brand orientation, instead of analyzing brand orientation as a single construct, this being the gap to be filled in this study. When analyzing each dimension and its relationships with the attitude towards charity and the donation intention, one can have an insight into what a Nonprofit Organization needs to do to develop an attitude towards charity and donation intention. It is demonstrated that each dimension behaves differently when they are inserted as antecedents of the attitude and intention constructs.

This approach is also justified because brand orientation plays an important role so that Nonprofit Organizations gain greater support from society, better perform fundraising and more satisfactorily fulfill their mission (Apaydin 2011; Kylander and Stone 2012). Given the above, in a practical way, the results of this study can provide managers of Nonprofit Organizations with a comprehensive insight into the contributions of brand orientation to these organizations, providing insights into how the dimensions of brand orientation affect attitude toward charity and donation intention. This allows them to identify if their brands have these dimensions, and thus develop strategies that can result in greater fundraising, better recruitment of volunteers, better organizational performance, among others, thus obtaining competitive advantages.

2 Theoretical framework

2.1 Nonprofit organizations

Nonprofit Organizations make up the economy of many countries and contribute to the well-being of society, exercising relevant roles of increasing importance in a global context (Lee and Markham 2015). These organizations offer, for example, religious, educational and health services (Hassay and Peloza 2009; Apaydin 2011; Smith 2018). In some countries, they offer more jobs than the for-profit sector, thus reiterating their growing social and economic relevance (Pope et al. 2009).

Like for-profit organizations, they also need resources to finance their operating costs and achieve their goals. However, they increasingly depend on donations from different external, individual and/or corporate sources (Mainardes et al. 2016; Valaskova 2019). According to Ranganathan and Henley (2008) and Mainardes et al. (2017), individual donations have been the main source of funding for these organizations.

In this context, given the significant increase in the number of Nonprofit Organizations, it is necessary to expand the fundraising through donations (Michel and Rieunier 2012; Laurett and Mainardes 2018). Nevertheless, the nonprofit sector is becoming more and more competitive, making the attraction of funds and volunteers more complex (Napoli 2006; Chad 2013). This hinders the development of activities and the fulfillment of the mission of Nonprofit Organizations (Apaydin 2011).

For this reason, it is necessary for such organizations to adapt to the dynamic environment in which they operate to obtain sustainable competitive advantages (Lee 2013). They need to, among other things, analyze how donors behave, identifying what encourages them to donate (Ranganathan and Henley 2008; Curran et al. 2016; Smith 2018). According to Laurett and Mainardes (2018), knowledge of donor behavior makes strategies for attracting and raising funds more consistent. Thus, in order to obtain more resources, non-profit organizations began to investigate donor behavior, verifying, for example, their intention to donate (Weerawardena and Mort 2008; Lwin et al. 2014).

2.2 Proposed model

In order to achieve the objective of this study, we proposed the model presented in Fig. 1. This model was built on the assumption that brand orientation can influence attitudes toward charity and donation intention (Webb et al. 2000; Ellen et al. 2006; Barone et al. 2007; Russell and Russell 2010), and that the attitude toward charity may influence donation intention (Dean 2002; Smith and McSweeney 2007; Teah et al. 2014). Therefore, the relations between the constructs that measured the effects of brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations on the attitude toward charity and donation intention were taken into consideration.

In this regard, the constructs of brand orientation were admitted as elements that influence the attitude toward charity and the donation intention (Webb et al. 2000; Dean 2002; Ellen et al. 2006; Barone et al. 2007; Russell and Russell 2010). The literature shows that the brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations generates positive consequences (Hankinson 2001; Ewing and Napoli 2005; Napoli 2006), enabling better performance and internal and external guidance (Hankinson 2000; Kumar et al. 2011). For this reason, it is expected that the factors which constitute the brand orientation of these organizations positively influence the attitude of Brazilians toward charity and their donations intentions.

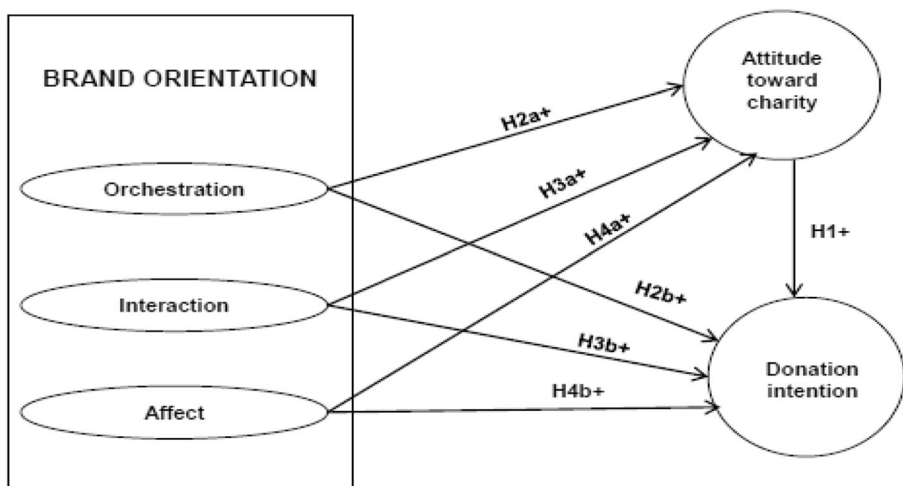


Fig. 1 Proposed model

It was assumed that the dimensions of brand orientation (orchestration, interaction and affect) are antecedents of both attitude towards charity and donation intention. In other words, the brand orientation activities of Nonprofit Organizations tend to be reflected in society and in behaviors of individuals (represented here by the attitude and intention). In the model developed for this study, the dimensions can influence the intention directly or through the attitude, meaning that the attitude may not always be necessary for the donation intention to happen. In this way, the model was developed with direct and indirect influences from the dimensions of the brand orientation on the donation intention.

2.3 Construct definitions

Intention is identified in the literature as an antecedent of individual behavior (Sheeshka et al. 1993; White et al. 2017). The Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) states that intentions are the closest predictors of real behavior (Ajzen 1991). Thus, the TPB is used to understand and predict human behavior, including donation (Canni re et al. 2009; Holdershaw et al. 2011). Mittelman and Rojas-M endez (2018) cite that the TPB has been widely used to predict donor intentions in a variety of activities, such as blood donation (Veldhuizen et al. 2011) and organ donation (Hyde and White 2009). However, although TPB has been successfully applied to predict the intention to donate (Knowles et al. 2012; Mittelman and Rojas-M endez 2018), its application is still limited in the context of charity (Webb et al. 2000; Kashif et al. 2015; Liu et al. 2019).

The attitude towards charity can be defined as the global and relatively long-lasting assessments of individuals in relation to non-profit organizations that help society (Webb et al. 2000). In this way, the creation of favorable attitudes is one of the main objectives of these organizations (Teah et al. 2014). Based on the definition of attitude to charity used in this study (Webb et al. 2000) and in its proposed objectives, the measurement of the attitude towards charity construct was carried out based on the adaptation of the scale by Dean (2002), which is used to measure attitude towards an event for people with disabilities. This scale was chosen because, after analyzing its content, it proved to be more adequate to fulfill the objectives of this research, compared to other scales, such as those employed by Van der Linden (2011) and by Schuyt et al. (2010), which indicate they are more focused on measuring the intentions of charity donation than the attitude.

Although brand building has long been adopted by commercial organizations as a means of gaining strategic advantages in a competitive market (Anees-ur-Rehman et al. 2016; Freitas and Almeida 2017; Hahn et al. 2016; Hankinson 2000; Lee 2013; Iyer et al. 2018), investigations into its relevance and attributions in the nonprofit sector are recent (Ewing and Napoli 2005; Hassay and Peloza 2009; Modi and Mishra 2010; Stebbins and Hartman 2013). Nonprofit Organizations serve diverse audiences, such as revenue providers, clients, beneficiaries, employees and volunteers, and compete with other organizations for funding, such as government funds, private and corporate donations, volunteer support and clients (Apaydin 2011; Chad et al. 2013). In light of this, brand orientation is relevant for these organizations (Anees-ur-Rehman et al. 2016; Hankinson 2000; Kumar et al. 2011; Pa o et al. 2014), representing broader attributions and providing guidance both internally and externally (Anees-ur-Rehman et al. 2016; Laidler-Kylander et al. 2007; Laidler-Kylander and Simonin 2009).

It was identified that many Nonprofit Organizations have adopted brand orientation as an element of competitiveness. By doing so, they seek to convey their values to their target audience in order to differentiate themselves from competitors (Hankinson 2001; Lee 2013; Stebbins and Hartman 2013), get more support and trust from society, improve fundraising, and better fulfill its role (Apaydin 2011; Chad 2013; Hankinson 2000; Kylander and Stone 2012). In this sense, the use of the brand as a strategic resource is being increasingly adopted by the nonprofit sector when it comes to obtaining resources and attracting volunteers (Apaydin 2011; Kylander and Stone 2012; Paço et al. 2014). Michel and Rieunier (2012) mention that the more favorable the brand, the greater the potential for attracting donations. This is because the brand orientation can contribute to the development of stakeholder confidence, the strengthening of awareness, the dissemination of the activities of these organizations and their values (Hankinson 2001; Wymer et al. 2016).

Among the investigations on brand orientation present in the literature (e.g., Hankinson 2000, 2001; Ewing and Napoli 2005; Mulyanegara 2011; Paço et al. 2014), there is the study developed by Napoli (2006), which sought to identify the effects of brand orientation, composed by the factors orchestration, interaction and affect, in the performance of Nonprofit Organizations of different sizes. The results showed a positive relationship between the dimensions of nonprofit brand orientation and organizational performance. It was also identified that the Nonprofit Organizations which are more successful are more likely to be brand oriented.

2.4 Donation intention

Among the investigations that analyze the behavior of individuals in terms of the intention to donate to Nonprofit Organizations, it is cited, for example, Michel and Rieunier (2012), Stebbins and Hartman (2013), Kashif et al. (2015), Mainardes et al. (2017), Mittelman and Rojas-Méndez (2018), Zhang et al. (2019) and Liu et al. (2019). In their study, Michel and Rieunier (2012) examined the elements that make up the brand image of Nonprofit Organizations and verified whether these images influence people's intentions to donate time or money. Stebbins and Hartman (2013) examined whether brand personalities of small charities influence donor behavior. The authors identified that the personality traits of these organizations impact on the donation behavior of individuals.

Kashif et al. (2015) sought to identify the factors that contribute to donation in Malaysia. It was noticed that past behavior, subjective norms and intentions to donate contribute positively to the real behavior of donating money. When investigating predictors of young people's intentions to donate money to charity in the future, Knowles et al. (2012) identified that attitude, moral norms and past behavior are significant.

In their research, Mainardes et al. (2017) aimed to recognize and classify external factors that encourage individuals from emerging countries to donate money and/or assets to Nonprofit Organizations. The results showed that the five elements suggested by the authors motivate the donation to these organizations: environmental and/or political aspects, the cause or situation of the donation, the characteristics of the organization, the influence of others and the effect of personal rewards.

In a research in Saudi Arabia, Alhidari et al. (2018) analyzed the effect of trust on individual monetary donations to Nonprofit Organizations. It was identified that trust is manifested when individuals understand that these organizations fulfill their mission, are honest in the use of donations and prioritize the rights of their beneficiaries. It was also verified that trust influences both donation intention and future behaviors of monetary donations.

Mittelman and Rojas-Méndez (2018), based on TPB, tested an expanded model of donations to charity, analyzing three dimensions of attitudes: in relation to a charity, in relation to aid and in relation to donation. They identified that the intention to donate is strongly influenced by past behaviors, subjective norms and perceived behavioral control. Similarly, also based on TPB, Liu et al. (2019) sought to identify the effect of power on donation intention. The results showed a greater intention of donation in individuals with a sense of power.

Zhang et al. (2019) verified the role of advertising appeals in donation intentions, studying mediating effects of social connection and competitive orientation. It turned out that a warm appeal tends to be more effective in attracting volunteers, and this relationship is mediated by the social connection. A competent appeal is more effective in attracting donations of money, and this relationship is mediated by competitive orientation.

In this context, Baghi and Gabrielli (2013) say branding represents a valuable strategic resource for the nonprofit sector when it comes to raising resources and attracting volunteers (Kylander and Stone 2012; Paço et al. 2014). This is because, for these organizations, the fact of being brand oriented contributes to achieving greater support and trust in society, positively affecting their intentions, which tends to result in greater fundraising and attraction of volunteers (Apaydin 2011; Chad 2013).

In this way, understanding the intentions of the donors has gained relevance for the professionals of the nonprofit sector (Ranganathan and Henley 2008), because identifying what drives individuals to donate to Nonprofit Organizations is relevant for the formulation of marketing strategies that wake in people favorable behavior to attitude toward charity (Kashif et al. 2015).

2.5 Attitude toward charity

In the literature there are studies that investigated attitudes towards charity in different situations, such as Webb et al. (2000), Dean (2002), Barone et al. (2007), Ranganathan and Henley (2008) and Bennett (2015). Webb et al. (2000) sought to measure the attitudes of individuals in relation to helping others and charitable organizations. They identified that people with positive attitudes toward nonprofits tend to support such organizations and see them as a suitable way to help others. The study by Dean (2002) sought to assess the immediate effect of fictitious corporate support for charitable events, observing the perceptions of the community related to the sponsoring company. The results showed that sponsoring charitable events results in a significant improvement in consumer attitudes and community relations with the company.

In his study, Bennett (2015) investigated the intrinsic types of emotions which are most strongly felt by people when they notice a charity advertisement. The objective was to perceive its consequences in the attitude toward the marketing of these organizations and in the donation intention. The author identified that the emotions

of the respondents are determinant to both the attitude towards the advertising of these organizations and the donation intention.

Smith and McSweeney (2007) aimed to identify latent sociopsychological factors that influence the decision to donate money to Nonprofit Organizations. Among other factors, the authors noticed that attitudes significantly precede donation intentions. Thus, measuring people's attitudes toward charity is relevant. This is due to the fact that such measures can be used to create and analyze theories of donation behavior, in addition to helping to allocate resources to these organizations and to contribute in the elaboration of marketing strategies capable of attracting and keeping donors (Webb et al. 2000; Bennett 2003).

In this sense, Lwin and Phau (2014) mention that attitudes towards Nonprofit Organizations significantly motivate donation intention. Smith and McSweeney (2007) and Briggs et al. (2010) state that people's attitudes toward charities precede their intentions of giving; that is, those who have positive attitudes towards these organizations are more inclined to donate (Teah et al. 2014; Gorczyca and Hartman 2017). Although the literature (e.g., Webb et al. 2000; Dean 2002; Bennett 2003; Smith and McSweeney 2007; Lwin et al. 2014; Gorczyca and Hartman 2017) indicates the influence of the attitude toward charity in donation intention, it was not identified the testing of this hypothesis in emerging markets, which is the novelty of this hypothesis specifically. For this reason, this study aimed to test said hypothesis in the researched context to ensure that such a relationship is also observed in that context. Thus, it was proposed:

H1: Attitude toward charity positively influences donation intention.

2.6 Brand orientation

As mentioned, Ewing and Napoli (2005) developed a scale to measure brand orientation in Nonprofit Organizations. This scale has 3 dimensions: orchestration, interaction and affect. These constructs are related to each other, as they are part of the larger construct brand orientation, but they are independent and this allows them to be tested separately, checking the influence of each one on the others. It is noteworthy that it is not possible to test the relationships between the constructs, as they make up a high-order construct.

The orchestration dimension analyzes the capacity of Nonprofit Organizations to develop activities capable of communicating the same image of the organization to its internal and external stakeholders, allowing nonprofit brand managers to act appropriately and perform their activities better (Hankinson 2001; Ewing and Napoli 2005). In this sense, the literature points out that a greater agreement in the perception of the stakeholders usually improves the attitudes of the clients toward the organizations and influences their purchase intentions (Ellen et al. 2006; Barone et al. 2007). In other words, orchestration can be understood as an antecedent of the attitude towards charity and the donation intention, responsible for ensuring that the communication activities of Nonprofit Organizations are reflected externally in society (Paço et al. 2014), which comprises current and potential donors. Thus, the following hypotheses were proposed:

H2a: The orchestration dimension positively influences attitude toward charity.

H2b: The orchestration dimension positively influences the donation intention.

The interaction dimension enables the creation of dialogue with stakeholders, providing an indication of the understanding of an organization's ability to respond

to changes in the market in which it operates and to the needs of its target audience (Ewing and Napoli 2005). Russell and Russell (2010) mention that a closer relationship between organizations and their stakeholders often interfere favorably in their behavior. Thus, broad interaction between a Nonprofit Organization and its public will certainly lead to better service delivery, increasing performance (Napoli 2006), which will possibly influence people's attitude toward charity and donation intention. In this study, it is assumed that the interaction of Nonprofit Organizations with their stakeholders can have an impact on the behavior of actors connected to the organization (internally and externally), which in turn can be reflected in positive behaviors of current and potential donors (Zhang et al. 2019), especially in their attitudes towards charity and donation intention. Therefore, interaction is, in this case, an antecedent of these two constructs. Based on the evidence presented, it was proposed:

H3a: The interaction dimension positively influences attitude toward charity.

H3b: The interaction dimension positively influences donation intention.

The affect dimension allows the development of detailed knowledge by the Non-profit Organizations on what their stakeholders like and what they do not like in their brands (Ewing and Napoli 2005). According to Urde et al. (2013), it is necessary for brand-oriented organizations to perceive how their brand-related activities are understood externally by their stakeholders. Webb et al. (2000) affirmed that identifying the preferences of the target public of Nonprofit Organizations can influence future attitudes toward these organizations and consequently impact donation intention. In this study, it was assumed that the knowledge which Nonprofit Organizations develop about their stakeholders tends to be reflected in society, including current and potential donors (Kylander and Stone 2012). Thus, the affect dimension tends to be an antecedent of individual behaviors, such as attitude and intention. For this reason, considering evidence presented, it was proposed:

H4a: The affect dimension positively influences the attitude toward charity.

H4b: The affect dimension positively influences donation intention.

In summary, brand orientation represents a tool which tends to enable a strategic growth of Nonprofit Organizations (Kylander and Stone 2012). After all, it can provide adequate communication with the press, volunteers, donors and public managers, contributing to the construction of a favorable public opinion and to the achievement of greater confidence from the society (Hankinson 2000). The novelty here is to analyze each dimension of the brand orientation separately. This can be a facilitating factor for the brand management by managers of Nonprofit Organizations, because, by knowing the influences of each dimension on the attitude towards charity and the donation intention, managers can direct their resources properly, instead of executing the brand orientation as one inseparable block. By specifying the influences of the tested dimensions, there can be a cost reduction in investments in Nonprofit Organizations' brands.

3 Methods

In order to verify the effect that the constituent factors of brand orientation exert on the attitude toward charity and donation intention, the target population of this research were Brazilians who know Nonprofit Organizations and are, therefore, potential

donors. As it is not possible to measure the universe of Brazilians who know Nonprofit Organizations, a non-probabilistic sampling was used.

It was opted the collection of primary data through the application of a questionnaire made available in an electronic medium. To ensure that the respondent understood the issues and was thus part of the research target audience, they were presented with a text explaining what a Nonprofit Organization is and containing known examples of this type of organization. Next, a control question was added, in which the respondent declared to know some Nonprofit Organization.

Thus, the questionnaire was initiated with the question of population control (do you know any Nonprofit Organization?) and then the affirmations referring to the constructs were arranged. The first affirmations comprised the dimensions which form the brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations according to the scale developed by Napoli (2006) containing 12 items (5 of orchestration, 5 of interaction and 2 of affect). The second construct was donation intention, evaluated by a scale containing 3 items adapted from the study by Wang et al. (2004). The third construct, attitude towards charity, was measured through a scale adapted from Dean (2002), which consisted of 4 items. This scale, employed by the author to measure the attitude towards Special Olympics, an event for people with disabilities, was used because it was the one whose object of analysis resembled the most the object of this study. In order to understand the profile of the sample, it was inserted questions to identify gender, age, schooling and income of the interviewees.

The questionnaire was elaborated in an online platform and sent as pre-test to 20 respondents, ask them about the difficulties of understanding it. With no difficulties being reported in the interpretation of the affirmations, the link of the questionnaire was sent through electronic mail, WhatsApp, Messenger and Facebook. In an attempt to increase the number of respondents and make the questionnaire available to Brazilians from all over the country, it was used an advertisement on Facebook. Data collection occurred between February and August 2018.

It was obtained a sample of 365 respondents, 25 of whom were excluded from the analysis because they answered NO in the question of population control. According to the data collected in relation to the sociodemographic profile, it was verified that the respondents were mostly female (67.8%) and the ages ranging from 16 to 25 years (36.9%) and 26 to 35 years (31.3%) were predominant. The most frequent levels of education in the sample were high school/technical (55.9%) and complete undergraduate (20.3%). Concerning the income brackets of the interviewees, most earned between 1 and 4 minimum wages (74.7%).

The researched sample was considered valid, as it represented the target population of the study considering the general donor characteristics found in other studies (for example, Michel and Rieunier 2012; Laurett and Mainardes 2018). It was also observed that the Brazilian donor, sample of this investigation, has a similar profile compared to the donor found in the international literature on donation (for example, Smith and McSweeney 2007; Alhidari et al. 2018) with the exception of some characteristics inherent to the Brazilian population such as lower age and education level.

In order to evaluate the proposed model, it was first performed the Confirmatory Factor Analysis (CFA), which presented the factor loadings matrix, Average Variance Extracted (AVE) and Composite Reliability (CR) of the analyzed constructs. Such measures made it possible to verify the convergent validity.

In order to ascertain the discriminant validity of the constructs, the factor loadings matrix and the criterion by Fornell and Larcker (1981), which makes a comparison of the square root of the AVE of each variable with the correlations between the other constructs, were verified. In order to have discriminant validity, the square root of the AVE must be greater than the value of these correlations (Hair Jr et al. 2014). As a technique to analyze relations and test the hypotheses, Structural Equation Modeling (SEM) with partial least squares (PLS) was used. This technique allows a set of dependency relations between the constructs to be verified simultaneously (Hair Jr et al. 2014).

4 Analysis and discussion of results

4.1 Validation of the structural model

To validate the structural model, the CFA was firstly carried out to verify the factor loadings of the variables measured. It was verified that most of the variables were significant, reaching a value equal to or greater than 0.60 in their factor loadings (Hair Jr et al. 2014). However, the variables OR1, OR3 and IN1 were excluded from the analysis because they did not present sufficient factor loadings (lower than 0.60), and a new CFA was performed without these items (Table 1).

Based on Table 1, also it was noticed that the factor loadings of the variables were higher in the construct itself, which shows the convergent validity, since the variables converge to the construct (Hair Jr et al. 2014). In addition, the distribution of factor loadings indicated the presence of several constructs, evidencing the discriminant validity.

From Table 2, it can be seen that the CR of the constructs obtained values above 0.70, demonstrating the robustness of the measures and indicating convergent validity of the constructs (Hair Jr et al. 2014). Regarding the AVE, all the constructs showed measurements greater than 0.50, which means that there is an adequate level of convergent validity.

In terms of the discriminant validity, the criterion by Fornell and Larcker (1981) were employed. It was identified, as highlighted in Table 2, that the square root of the AVE presented was greater than the value of the correlations between the other constructs. Based on this, the discriminant validity of the measurement model was confirmed. Therefore, based on the analysis of the convergent validity and the discriminant validity of the constructs, it was verified that the measurement model used in this research appears to be appropriate, showing adequacy between the adopted theory and the study's data (Hair Jr et al. 2014). In addition, as a final validation, the VIF (Variance Inflation Factor) of the indicators that remained after the exclusions was checked. The results varied between 1.2 and 3.4, within the limits indicated by the literature (Hair Jr et al. 2014).

4.2 Hypothesis analysis and discussion

Based on the objectives of this study, the analysis of the significance of the relationships suggested by the hypotheses developed was carried out, verifying that the

Table 1 Factor Loadings Matrix

Constructs	Variables	AC	AF	OR	DI	IN
Attitude toward charity (AC)	AC1 I admire Nonprofit Organizations	0.85				
	AC2 I have respect for Nonprofit Organizations	0.84				
	AC3 Nonprofit Organizations act with worthy causes	0.81				
	AC4 The objectives of Nonprofit Organizations are relevant	0.69				
Affect(AF)	AF1 Nonprofit Organizations seek to know what people disapprove in their services		0.87			
	AF2 Nonprofit Organizations seek to know what people like in their services		0.90			
Orchestration(OR)	OR1 I am directly encouraged by the marketing activities of Nonprofit Organizations to use their services and donate time, money and/or goods to the organizations themselves;			DRP		
	OR2 I believe that the brand of Nonprofit Organizations represents their activities;			0.76		
	OR3 I am encouraged by the marketing activities of the Nonprofit Organizations to promote and disclose their services;			DRP		
	OR4 The marketing programs of Nonprofit Organizations convey consistent messages about their brands and activities;			0.84		
	OR5 I realize and understand well what brands of Nonprofit Organizations represent;			0.69		
Donation Intention (DI)	DI1 I intend to use the services and/or donate time, money and/or goods to Nonprofit Organizations;				0.80	
	DI2 Whenever I can, I recommend to others the services of the Nonprofit Organizations that I know.				0.80	
	DI3 I intend to maintain a close and long-term relationship with the Nonprofit Organizations I know;				0.84	
Interaction (IN)	IN1 I have had positive experiences with the services provided by the Nonprofit Organizations;					DRP
	IN2 Nonprofit Organizations usually have ways to receive suggestions from their target audience;					0.69
	IN3 The adequate investments made by the Nonprofit Organizations to improve the delivery of their services makes me attribute more value to these organizations;					0.78
	IN4 When I need it, Nonprofit Organizations meet my needs;					0.70
	IN5 I consider that Nonprofit Organizations have deep knowledge of the sector in which they operate.					0.76

Caption: DRP = Drooped

Table 2 Ave, Composite Reliability and Correlation Between Constructs

Constructs	AVE	CR	AC	AF	OR	DI	IN
Attitude toward charity (AC)	0.64	0.88	0.80				
Affect(AF)	0.79	0.88	0.34	0.91			
Orchestration(OR)	0.58	0.81	0.49	0.39	0.76		
Donation Intention (DI)	0.66	0.85	0.49	0.37	0.28	0.81	
Interaction (IN)	0.51	0.80	0.52	0.49	0.55	0.46	0.71

Caption: AVE – Average Variance Extracted; CR – Composite Reliability

Note: The values highlighted on the main diagonal correspond to the square roots of the AVE from each construct

majority was significant (Fig. 2). Then, the findings of this research were compared with the results of similar studies on brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations, attitude toward charity and donation intention.

The logic proposed by the model employed in this study was that the dimensions of brand orientation (orchestration, interaction and affect) are positioned as antecedents of the attitude towards charity and the donation intention. Recognizing which dimensions influence both constructs can facilitate the targeting of Nonprofit Organizations' resources when developing their brand orientation strategy. As shown in the sequence, dimensions behave differently.

Out of the 3 dimensions tested, only 2 influence the attitude towards charity (orchestration and interaction) and 2 influence the donation intention (interaction and affect). The interaction is the only one which influences both constructs and consequently should receive the attention of the managers of Nonprofit Organizations. The affect influences only the donation intention, which indicates that investing in the elements which make up the affect dimension does not tend to generate an attitude towards charity and, for this reason, such an investment can be a waste of resources. Orchestration, on the other hand, only influences the attitude towards charity, which

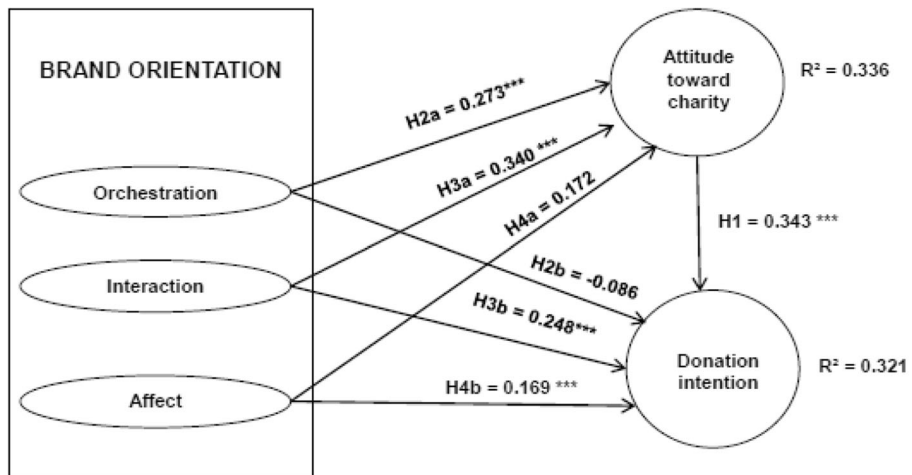


Fig. 2 Results of proposed model

indicates that investing in the aspects that make up orchestration to obtain donations directly may not have the expected result, as it will be necessary to generate attitude towards charity beforehand. The details of the analysis and discussion of each hypothesis can be seen below.

Based on the results presented in fig. 2, it was verified that the hypothesis H1, which suggests the positive influence of attitude towards charity in the donation intention, was supported ($\beta = 0.343$, p value < 0.01). The result of this research, as expected, strengthens previous findings (for example Webb et al. 2000; Bennett 2003; Smith and McSweeney 2007; Lwin et al. 2014; Teah et al. 2014), pointing out that the respondents' attitude toward charity tends to influence donation intentions. In other words, it was identified that the attitude to charity tends to lead them to use the services provided by the Nonprofit Organizations, to make donations of time, money and/or goods and to recommend the services provided by those organizations to other people. Moreover, it tends to favor their intention to maintain a close and lasting relationship with the Nonprofit Organizations they know. This means that if attitudes towards charity are encouraged in people, it can result in donation intentions, which is the main antecedent of donation behavior (Mainardes et al. 2017). The next step would be to analyze what can stimulate the attitude towards charity; more specifically, in this study, if the dimensions of the brand orientation stimulate such an attitude as well as the intention to donate, which was observed in the other hypotheses.

Hypothesis H2a, which dealt with the orchestration dimension positively influencing the attitude toward charity, was supported ($\beta = 0.273$, p value < 0.01). This result points out that a greater harmony in the perception of the stakeholders usually improves the attitudes of the individuals towards the organizations, resulting in more resources (Ellen et al. 2006; Barone et al. 2007). Therefore, it is evident that the orchestration of the brand of Nonprofit Organizations - that is, the representation of its activities by means of the brands, the transmission of consistent messages about their brands and activities through marketing programs - tends to favor the attitude towards charity. Thus, among other things, orchestration may influence the admiration and respect that these individuals have towards Nonprofit Organizations. In this way, developing a brand orientation that clearly demonstrates the activities of Nonprofit Organizations can stimulate an attitude towards charity in people. Moreover, the marketing and brand management programs should be carried out professionally and taken seriously by Nonprofit Organizations. The orchestration can enable non-profit organizations to develop activities capable of communicating the same internal and external image, which helps them to better perform their services and achieve their goals.

The hypothesis that suggests the positive influence of orchestration on donation intention (H2b) has been rejected ($\beta = -0.086$, p value > 0.05). Thus, unlike previous studies (for example, Hankinson 2001; Ewing and Napoli 2005), which pointed out that the orchestration of nonprofit brand orientation may result in more donation intention, the findings of this investigation suggest that the fact that these organizations send the same image to their internal and external stakeholders does not tend to directly impact the intention to donate time, money and/or goods to these organizations nor the use of the services they offer. This relationship may be mediated through other factors, which needs to be verified in future investigations. In other words, the proper communication of the image of a Nonprofit Organization through the orientation of its brand does not guarantee intentions of donation, but other elements, such as the attitude towards charity itself, may influence the donation intentions.

In relation to the interaction dimension, both hypotheses were supported: H3a ($\beta = 0.340$, $p \text{ value} < 0.01$), related to the interaction exerting positive influence on the attitude towards charity, and H3b ($\beta = 0.248$, $p \text{ value} < 0.01$), which proposed that the interaction positively influences the donation intention. Therefore, it is suggested that a closer relationship between Nonprofit Organizations and their stakeholders can stimulate attitudes towards charity and this can be accomplished through the orientation of the organizations' brand, which is characterized by the availability of channels through which people can provide suggestions and by the appropriate use of the resources that these organizations have, can stimulate attitudes towards charity (Napoli 2006; Russell and Russell 2010). In addition, the results expand the understanding of the contributions of the interaction dimension, indicating that it tends to help Nonprofit Organizations understand the needs of its target audience, enabling them to respond adequately to the transformations of the market in which they operate. Therefore, guiding Nonprofit Organizations' brands to interact with society can result in attitudes towards charity, and that requires a specific effort from the managers of this type of organization.

Furthermore, it was observed that the interaction dimension exerts a positive influence on donation intention (H3b). It is evident that the motivation to make different types of donations for Nonprofit Organizations as well as to use the services they provide and recommend their services to others tends to be influenced by the interaction of the brand with the stakeholders of these organizations. The results show that the interaction can influence attitudes and intentions (Napoli 2006; Russell and Russell 2010), hence indicating that this dimension can offer significant benefits for Nonprofit Organizations by allowing them to better manage the relationship with their stakeholders. Undoubtedly, the main benefit may be the intention to donate, which tends to result in effective donations (Mainardes et al. 2017). This means that, when orienting the Nonprofit Organization brand, the manager can focus on interaction with society, since the expected effect tends to be favorable to the organization itself.

Still based on the findings presented in Fig. 2, the hypothesis which suggested the positive influence of the affect dimension on attitude toward charity (H4a) was rejected ($\beta = 0.172$, $p \text{ value} > 0.05$). This result appears to be in disagreement with the findings by Webb et al. (2000), Napoli (2006) and Urde et al. (2013), which point out that seeking to know the preferences of the stakeholders tends to influence the attitudes of these individuals and the performance of Nonprofit Organizations in a positive way. In this sense, it is evident that the affect, represented by the effort of these organizations in finding out what people approve or not in their services, tends not to exert an influence on the attitude toward charity. Such results suggest that the fact that non-profit organizations seek to know what individuals like or dislike in their services does not tend to be enough for people to perceive the causes defended by Nonprofit Organizations as worthy and their goals as relevant, and to have respect and admiration for these organizations. Therefore, differently from what was expected, taking people's opinions about Nonprofit Organizations into account when orienting their brand tends not to have an effect on people's attitude towards charity. Other elements positively impact the attitude towards charity (as seen here, orchestration and interaction), but this is not the case with affect.

Unlike H4a, hypothesis H4b ($\beta = 0.169$, $p \text{ value} < 0.01$), which suggested the positive influence of the affect dimension on donation intention, was supported. It was

evident that the donation intention to Nonprofit Organizations tends to be motivated by the search of what the stakeholders approve or disapprove in their brands and services, as suggested by Webb et al. (2000) and Napoli (2006). Thus, the affect dimension of Nonprofit Organizations brand tends to influence the intention to make donations and may motivate, among other things, the intentions of these individuals to donate time, money and/or goods. Although it does not influence the attitude towards charity, the affect dimension of Nonprofit Organizations' brand orientation can directly influence donation intention. For this reason, it is important that organizations of this type know their stakeholders in depth, as donations have been one of the main means of subsistence for them (Mainardes et al. 2017). This finding points out the importance of Nonprofit Organizations' managers getting closer to their stakeholders and developing the orientation of their brands focusing on this aspect.

The determination coefficient (R^2) was used in order to measure to what extent the attitude toward charity and donation intention can be explained by the orchestration, interaction and affect dimensions. The attitude towards charity obtained $R^2 = 0.34$, which indicates that the orchestration and interaction dimensions of the brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations explain in 34% the construct attitude toward charity. The donation intention construct presented $R^2 = 0.32$, which suggests that it is explained in 32% by the dimensions of interaction, attitude toward charity and affect. In this context, it can be noted that the relevance of Nonprofit Organizations being brand oriented, that is, that they create, develop and maintain their brands (Liu et al. 2015), knowing that this provokes in people attitudes favorable to charity and influences them to make donations, which consequently helps these organizations to perform better and achieve their objectives (Kylander and Stone 2012).

In summary, it is considered that developing and correctly transmitting the dimensions of brand orientation (orchestration, interaction and affect) can help Nonprofit Organizations obtain competitive advantages even in an increasingly competitive scenario, because this tool can favorably influence donor behavior (Kylander and Stone 2012; Sargeant 1999). Based on the results presented, it was noted that the use of marketing mechanisms related to brands, specifically to brand orientation, can offer significant benefits to the Nonprofit Organizations, allowing them to better manage the relationship with their stakeholders and thus, perform their role better. Therefore, in order to raise more funds and achieve better results in the dynamic context in which they operate, Nonprofit Organizations can make use of these tools (Apaydin 2011; Laidler-Kylander et al. 2007).

Thus, this study concluded that the brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations, as well as the adequate development of marketing programs, can be fundamental for the managers of Nonprofit Organizations. Among other things, it can provide these organizations with greater trust, admiration, respect and support from their target audience, thus increasing the fundraising and attraction of volunteers, which contributes to the achievement of a better organizational performance and satisfactory fulfillment of its mission (Kylander and Stone 2012). In this context, since brand orientation plays a significant role in the elaboration of strategies and results in significant advantages for Nonprofit Organizations (Hankinson 2001; Venable et al. 2005), it can be concluded that the absence of a solid brand orientation could jeopardize the survival of these organizations.

5 Conclusions

The objective of this study was to verify the effects that dimensions of the brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations (orchestration, interaction and affect) exert in the attitude toward charity and donation intention. Additionally, it aimed to verify the influence of the attitude toward charity in donation intention. The results indicated that the dimensions of brand orientation can influence in different ways the attitude toward charity and the donation intention. Moreover, it pointed out that the donation intention of these individuals tends to be positively influenced by the attitude toward charity, as expected.

For this reason, it is recommended that Nonprofit Organizations seek to understand and encourage people's attitude towards charity, and, based on this, to establish marketing strategies to attract donations of time, money and/or goods. It is also suggested that these organizations be strongly brand oriented internally and externally in order to create and maintain cohesive and consistent brands, which are capable of positively affecting the attitude toward charity and the donation intention and of contributing to their permanence in the market.

Brand orientation can represent a competitive differential for Nonprofit Organizations in the scenario in which they act, because it allows them to communicate the same image of their brands both internally and externally, develop better communication with their target audience and know their preferences, thus generating attitude toward charity and donation intention. This occurs from a greater understanding of the activities of the Nonprofit Organizations, aligning their brands to the activities that they execute, developing means to receive suggestions from their stakeholders and identifying their approvals and disapprovals regarding the services delivered, thus providing orchestration, interaction and affect towards these individuals.

The present research contributed theoretically regarding the brand of Nonprofit Organizations, advancing studies in this area by developing and testing a model capable of indicating the relationship between the factors that compose the their brand orientation (orchestration, interaction and affect) with the attitude toward charity and the donation intention. This enables a better understanding of brand contributions to the charity sector and identifies their influences on factors external to these organizations. This study also contributes theoretically as it is the first one to investigate how the brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations influences the attitude toward charity and the donation intention, because no previous studies were found in the scientific literature which proposed and tested such relationships. Thus, this research shows how marketing practices similar to those employed in the commercial sector can be attractive to the charity sector, identifying how brand orientation motivates people to donate to Nonprofit Organizations and influences their attitude towards charity.

As a practical contribution, the results of this research provide the managers of Nonprofit Organizations with a broader view of the benefits of brand orientation for their organizations, since it provides information on how attitude toward charity and people's donation intention are influenced by the dimensions of brand orientation. Therefore, managers can check whether their brands have the dimensions presented and develop strategies that can lead their organizations to achieve greater support from society, thus obtaining more resources, attracting more volunteers and improving the services rendered, which will certainly guarantee them advantages for a better social performance.

It should be mentioned, as limitations of the study, the fact that the sample had a small number of respondents, which does not allow the results to be generalized. Despite this limitation, the results provide evidence of behaviors that can be confirmed in future studies. Another limitation concerns the model proposed in the study, which is summarized in the analysis of the influences of the brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations by only two factors (attitude toward charity and donation intention). It is recommended that further studies be developed with models which identify the effects of brand orientation on other factors external to Nonprofit Organizations, thus increasing the understanding of this subject in this sector.

For future research, it can be suggested research comparing the influence of brand orientation of Nonprofit Organizations on the attitude toward charity and donation intention of Brazilians with people from other countries, such as the United States, Canada, the United Kingdom and Australia. Finally, it is recommended the development of research which identifies the influence of the brand orientation dimensions on attitude toward charity and donation intention according to the segment of the Nonprofit Organizations in order to identify if the type of organization interferes in the results, increasing or decreasing the effects of brand orientation on people's attitude toward charity and their donation intentions to such organizations.

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Compliance with ethical standards

Conflict of interest On behalf of all authors, the corresponding author states that there is no conflict of interest.

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